

The Gazette Looking back

100 years ago — October 10, 1890

In last week's Gazette we predicted that the North Lanark Agricultural Society's exhibition of this year (which had just opened) would eclipse all its predecessors; and now that it is over we feel certain all will concede that our prediction has been verified. The weather, with the exception of Friday forenoon, was all that would be wished for; the crowd that passed through the gates was larger than ever before.

Queen's University opened on Wednesday last with the largest attendance since its establishment. Altogether there are more than 500 students in attendance. There is an unusually large number of lady students present this session.

At the Welland assizes, Arthur H. Day was convicted of murdering his wife by shoving her over the embankment at Niagara Falls, and was sentenced to be hanged on November 18th.

50 years ago — October 10, 1940

Eighteen men of from 21 to 23 left for at least a month's military training Wednesday morning. They were all from Almonte and the rural district surrounding it.

Thirteen boys, all juveniles, appeared in District Magistrate's Court, Almonte, this Thursday morning, charged with offences ranging from stealing bicycles, stealing out of parked cars to shop lifting. As usual the Magistrate, Donald C. Smith, and the Crown-Attorney, Wm. W. Bollock, were somewhat perplexed as to the punishment that should be imposed in a juvenile case of this kind. The Magistrate ordered parents of two boys to give them a sound flogging when they got home. He lined the thirteen up in front of him and gave them a severe lecture after which he ordered they were to go straight home from school and straight back to school...He made it clear to culprits and parents that this was the last time such informal punishment would be meted out under similar circumstances.

25 years ago — October 7, 1965

Great damage was done to the Collie Textile Mill at Almonte Friday night, when fire broke out about 9:30. It was caused by overheated material in a carding machine. The sprinkler system came on automatically and extinguished this blaze but not before sparks flew up a feeding shoot to the third storey where the material now used for spinning was stored. When the fire broke out on this level, Mr. James E. Collie, who happened to be there, and the hands working this night shift, realized it was a job for the fire brigade and vacated the building after phoning in an alarm.

Desmond M. Code, 52-year-old former mayor of Smiths Falls, was the unanimous choice of the Lanark County Progressive Conservative Association as their candidate in the Nov. 8 federal election at their nominating convention in Carleton Place last Saturday afternoon. Both Grant Campbell and Willys Armour pledged their support to the winner and moved that the result of the voting be made unanimous.

International honour came to the memory of Canada's great surgeon-sculptor, Tait McKenzie, on Oct. 2 at his former home and studio, the Mill of Kintail near Almonte. The American Association for State and Local History gave its Honour Award of Merit to Major and Mrs. J.F. Leisy for preserving the Mill of Kintail as a memorial to Tait McKenzie and for founding the memorial Museum.

10 years ago — October 8, 1980

The wheels of government turned slowly last week and came only a fraction closer to deciding the fate of the disputed Lahey subdivision near Carleton Place. Chairman William Dyer of the Ontario Municipal Board deferred his decision on the approval of a zoning bylaw that would have allowed the development of a 30-acre housing subdivision near Glen Isle. Local landowners have objected to the zoning on the grounds the subdivision will detract from the natural beauties of this country setting.

The third try-out for the new Almonte Intermediate "A" team took place on Sunday with 28 players. "Support from local players has not really materialized yet," Bill Shephard, manager and coach said Monday. Players from Almonte who have tried out so far are Donny and Jim Vaughan, Brian Lynch, Steve Baird, Guy Thurston, Brian Sonnenburg and Don Gillis.

It became apparent at a recent Almonte St. Mary's PTA meeting that some parents feel unable to turn to the Children's Aid Society (CAS) for help with a youngster in difficulty. The meeting presented a slide show on drug abuse and raised the question from one parent "where do I go for help if I suspect I have a child in trouble with drugs?" One parent commented "CAS would be the last place I would call under such circumstances" when the agency was suggested by Perth OPP Const. Barry Boyce.

Columns

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Pic of the Past

In a week of football nostalgia, we take a peek at some cheerleaders of yore. The cheering squad of 1962 consisted of (back row) Kathy Wright, Capt. Ruth Leishman, Patsy Price, Janet Rodger, Rose Marie McDonald, (front row) Grace Guthrie, Shirley Boal, Norah Hourigan, Judy Southwell and Joy Mor-

ton. The photo, taken by M. Stone, was submitted to the Gazette by Ruth Leishman, who now lives in Orleans. Note: Bob Frances has identified the man in last week's photo as Mr. James F. Patterson, former druggist. The picture showed him standing by the stone bridge in town around 1910.

Golden eagle puts on dramatic show

A rare golden eagle made a dramatic appearance last week on Mel Taylor's lawn in Montgomery Park on the lower Mississippi Lake. Settling down for only half a minute, it then glided out over the water for a duck kill. Unfortunately for the eagle, the duck was one of Mel's decoys. Thrown off by the duck's unyielding back, the eagle toppled into the water and then quickly hopped and flopped onto the nearby dock. With wings dripping water, it rested a while, long enough for Mel to get a few shots away (from his camera). He got to within 30 feet of the huge bird before it took off and flew low down the shore. If anyone else spotted this huge eagle, please call in.

The occasional golden eagle has been reported this year in the Westport area, where it is suspected to have nested. Perhaps the Taylors' bird could have been of this family.

The golden eagle, an all-brown bird with a wingspan of over two metres, gets its name from the lighter head feathers which shine in the sunlight. Spotted irregularly throughout most of North America and Northern Europe, their

Strictly for the Birds

By Cliff Bennett
256-4511



best fieldmark besides their size, is feathers right down to the toes. The immature has a white tail band with a terminal black band and some white under the wings. They feed on insects, mice, owls, grouse and groundhogs. They sometimes eat carrion and will attack fairly large animals when really hungry.

Golden eagles usually nest on rocky ledges overlooking open fields and also, at times, in tall trees. Used yearly, the nest soon becomes very large for they add a new layer each year. Two whitish eggs are laid each year and the chicks hatch in 42-45 days. Brooding and self-feeding

take two months; usually the smallest one dies. Most eagles migrate south, chasing the ground animals. Many are electrocuted landing on high tension wires or shot by hunters and farmers. Some get caught in steel traps or die from eating poisoned bait. Golden eagles have been known to equal the peregrine



families, one of which nested in a martin house. Together they yielded 16 young falcon in flight speeds of 120 mph.

Bluebirds are gathering in flocks this past week, prior to moving off south.

Rolph Meier, Dwyer Hill Road in West Carleton, spotted a flock of 20, after having had a very successful summer raising them. Rolph listed three different ones. Bluebirds winter in the USA, starting just below the frost line. From all accounts, this has been the bluebirds' best breeding year yet.

It's time to start thinking about your bird feeders. Many have theirs in place now, some have been feeding all summer. Carol Crawford, Almonte, has two feeders in place and wishes she could receive a visit from the cardinals she's been hearing in the area all summer. Carol also came upon a turkey vulture alongside the highway east of Almonte. It was feasting on a road kill. Earl Webb put his feeders up recently and gained 12 species the first day. He noted many white-throated sparrows. Watch for specials on bird feed at Ashton Feed Store.

Around here, on our Clayton area property, we've been swamped with juncos. We also had a raven and I heard two different barred owls last Friday eve-

Letters

It's difficult to say goodbye

To the Editor:

It is hard to say goodbye after nearly 45 years on Rural Route #4. Although Roy's father, William Thompson drove the mail initially with a horse and buggy, the actual contract has always been in Roy's name.

We have seen many changes in that time. George Thompson is the only original patron still receiving mail. In 1946 we delivered to only 38 mailboxes and now service about 190, not including group boxes at the Greystone Estates.

People's lifestyle's have changed. In the early years we shared in our neighbor's joys and their sorrows as they chatted at the mailbox. We often were called upon to bring out a few groceries or to drive someone into town on an errand. Some days we found the time to stop off at a home to deliver a thermos of soup to someone who wasn't well. In return, we would open a mailbox and find some homebaking or a special remembrance.

Now most of our old friends and neighbors have moved and farms have been sold to people from the city. Everyone works during the day and no one has the time to talk along the way. While in the early years we knew all the folk and their children, now it's a challenge to keep up with people's boarders and even pets who receive birthday cards these days!

For many years Vera ran the route herself when the weather was good. Our children tell the story of how the other kids used to refer to their mother as "the Mail Lady" as she drove past the school house. Being a working mother was a rarity in those days and the mail route had its advantages. Vera was always home to

see my children off to school and could be there when they returned. The job provided a regular income—a luxury that a farmer did not always have!

Being outside "come rain or shine" through all the seasons, we came closer to nature from the first spring flowers (and mud) to the beauty of a summer morning, the changing colors of the fall to the drifts of snow which certainly weren't always as well plowed as they are now.

With all the pros to our job as rural mail drivers, there were also cons. As contract workers, we received no benefits—no Canada Pension, Unemployment Insurance or Superannuation. With all the other changes we have seen in Canada Post and its service, we feel that benefits could have been improved, as they have for other public servants and Members of Parliament.

We wish to thank the four Postmasters with whom we worked (namely: Hal Kirkland, Margaret Johnston, Stewart Lancaster and Andrew Mortimer). We also want to thank our bondsmen Geo Thompson 1946-1990 and Keith Brydges 1979-1990.

We have enjoyed the camaraderie of our fellow workers at the post office over the years and want to thank all those on RR 4 who appreciated our service and were so kind to us at Christmas. To our successor: We hope you enjoy as many good years, laughs and people -- and that you will finally get a pension!

Goodbye and thank you,
Roy and Vera Thompson,
Mail Couriers (1946-1990)

Swedish system is not utopian

The following is a copy of a letter sent to Premier-elect Bob Rae in Toronto.

Dear Sir:

This morning in a TV interview, I heard you cite Sweden as a country that has had a successful Social Democratic government. Well, based on a personal look at their system, I suggest that the great majority of Canadians may be a long way from ready for that kind of 'big-brother' model.

In practical economic terms, just a couple of basic comparative examples, from memory, that we found during a forest industry study tour of Sweden in the seventies:

- The average Swede paid income taxes of at least twice the level being paid in Canada at that time. For example, a Swedish forest engineer friend of mine had lost 25 per cent of his gross salary in income taxes while working in Canada the year prior to our visit to his homeland; a year later, having been transferred back to Sweden, and with the same salary, his equivalent Swedish taxes amounted to 65 per cent. Thus, bureaucrats there would spend two-thirds of his salary for him as opposed to somewhat less than a third here. Since then the disparity has likely changed to our detriment but the gap is likely still significant.

- At the corporate level, contrary to the policies you seem to espouse, combined Federal/Provincial taxes were much lower in Sweden. For example, at that time I worked for a multinational forest industry company whose income tax rate was just over 50 per cent. The equivalent company in Sweden was then being taxed at about the 30 per cent level on its taxable profits. I say taxable profits, because, in addition to this very favorable income-tax rate, the Swedish company was also permitted to earmark a significant portion of its annual profits for

future modernization and thus create a tax-free nestegg favoring its future competitiveness.

At the consumer level, we found that anything considered as luxuries such as liquor, cigarettes, gasoline, jewelry, and the like, were all about twice as expensive as here, while food and ordinary clothing were about equivalently priced. Salaries and wages also seemed about on par.

At about the same time, a learned former professor of mine had done a much more in-depth socio-economic study of the Swedish system for his University. In a nutshell his conclusion to me was: "Yes, Nels, the Swedes are looked after from the cradle to the grave but it is one hell of an expensive trip."

The question to you, Sir, is do you think Ontarians are prepared to let you lead us into a Swedish-type utopia(????), or would you consider the possibility that they, and Canadians in general, are fed up with having financially pampered Federal/Provincial politicians and bureaucrats dispense the bulk of their hard earned pensions, salaries and wages, much of it for the principal purpose of getting re-elected, or for after election rewards?

Incidentally, I'm an industrial pensioner and I assure you that I do not enjoy anything like the economic largess that 40 years of taxation has helped provide public servants, politicians and fellow travelers. This kind of gross unfairness to the industrial worker is something you might undertake to correct, in Ontario at least - small chance!!

Sincerely,
Nelson R. Williams
Almonte.